



HIDDEN WIKI MAGIC



We usually don't dish out life hacks in this section but this one

has to be let out. This simple trick will help you move out of your Wikipedia comfort zone allowing you to explore more deep into Wikipedia's dark core. It's all about utilising Wikipedia's Special:Random page. Find out more here: <http://dgit.in/randminf>

SQUATTER RESURGENCE?

The body that regulates Internet addresses is checking to see if it can crack down on a Canadian company accused of using the new ".sucks" domain name to extract exorbitant sums from celebrities and companies seeking to protect their public brands. <http://dgit.in/suks>

IN SCIENCE WE DON'T TRUST



We live in an age when scientific knowledge from climate change to vaccinations – faces furious opposition. Is it because scientific truths that are less than self-evident, often mind-blowing, sometimes hard to swallow? Read on: <http://dgit.in/inscivtrst>

WHY C DRIVE FOR YOUR HDD?



For nearly as long as hard disk drives have been placed in personal computers running certain popular operating systems (notably MS-DOS/Windows), the primary hard disk has been designated with the letter "C". But why? After following this link it won't be hard for you to C why. <http://dgit.in/cdrivez>

Internet plan to access certain websites or services.

On the other hand, if we are to take an optimistic (albeit unrealistic) view of the intents of the ISPs and telcos, then in a country without net neutrality we could see the most common and popular apps being completely free to use with respect to data charges and the overall cost of data use falling because ISPs no longer have to only rely on the end user for revenue. As I said, it sounds unrealistic.

Nevertheless, wherever you stand on the debate, it's clear that net neutrality does directly affect you and as a result, you should know and care about it.

Everybody and their grandmother supports net neutrality, is there a contrarian viewpoint?

As it always happens in a debate, net neutrality is being both derided and defended by different parties. And even though it may appear like net neutrality has received universal support, it is important to understand the other side of the debate as well.

But first, let's take a quick look at why net neutrality is being defended:

1. Without net neutrality, it would be very easy for ISPs to mould the browsing habits of its users with the help of pricing slabs, different speeds for different sites and other methods. So, if Airtel wanted its users to visit Flipkart, it would make it exceedingly easy and advantageous to do so and put competing sites on the back foot which would clearly be an anti-competition move.
2. Net neutrality also ensures that small, new companies can compete against established big names on the Internet fairly. If net neutrality did not exist then big companies would shackle their

competition with the implicit ability to be able pay more to the ISPs to ensure better service, something that most start-ups wouldn't be able to do.

3. Now, this scenario may lie at the furthest end of the slippery slope, but here it is: since the absence of net neutrality could mean that an ISP will get money from companies, that relationship may be enough to compel the ISP to mute online criticism against one of its paying partners.
4. Another scenario that exists without net neutrality is that the Internet becomes a stratified mess and you'll be forced to choose packages of websites and services like you do with your DTH subscription. If you want unrestricted access to the Internet, the ISPs could force you to pay through the nose.
5. The anti-net neutrality arguments become even more vociferous when it comes to VoIP and messaging apps like WhatsApp and Viber. Since these services directly affect the telcos' bottom-line, there is the significant possibility that the companies behind these apps will have to register for licenses in order to conduct operations in India. This means that unless the companies behind messaging and VoIP apps decide to pay the government for licenses, you won't be able to use them.

These are only a few of the many arguments that net neutrality proponents put forward in defence of keeping the Internet neutral. However, when we get to the debate against net neutrality, the focus of the arguments is essentially different. While the pro net neutrality talking points almost always have the consumer as their focal point, the other side of the debate seems to be focused on the telecom operators and how a 'neutral' Internet ensures financial doom. In

fact, TRAI recently published a consultation paper that almost exclusively focuses on how many VoIP services, apps and websites are taking undue advantage of the infrastructure set up by telcos who spent bucketloads of money setting it all up.

There is, however, one aspect of the telcos services, which goes against net neutrality, that appears worth considering, especially in a country like India. I am specifically talking about a service like Internet.org which could work as a great tool to increase Internet penetration in rural areas and places where Internet use is often looked at as a luxury. Do I wish services like Internet.org offered more choice or even let users pick the websites that they'd want to access for free? Yes, that would be ideal but I'm also aware of the economic realities. If the scope of services like Internet.org is focused towards increasing rural Internet penetration and awareness, then I can't really argue against it, not when I have easy access to the Internet at relatively decent speeds while many others don't.

With the recent revelation about Airtel Zero, and how it would make certain websites freely accessible, the debate has become even more important. Indian Internet policy is still young and malleable and this is a very important time to help shape it so that it continues to be open and democratic.

Digit stands for net neutrality and we hope we've helped you understand both sides of the debate in order to help you make up your mind on where you stand. The net neutrality debate is integral to the policy framework that will govern the Internet in India and it's very important that we help it manifest in a form that's fair to everyone currently on the Internet and those aspiring to be so. Read the full article at the following link <http://dgit.in/NetNeutrality101> 